

FULL SEO AUDIT REPORT

daviselen.com

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41/₁₀₀

SEO Health Score

September 01, 2026 Full Audit

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive SEO audit of **daviselen.com** for a **Agency (advertising / creative services, multi-location)** site, generated on September 01, 2026. Findings combine technical, content, schema, performance, visual, and search-readiness evidence as available.

41/100

SEO HEALTH SCORE

Critical Issues Found:

1. **Critical:** Zero headings sitewide - not one <h1>-<h6> element in the rendered DOM on the homepage
2. **Critical:** WordPress demo pages and a test page are live, indexable, and listed in the XML sitemap
3. **Critical:** Cumulative Layout Shift of 0.58 on the homepage, 5.8x the 0.10 'good' threshold
4. **High:** 23 of 30 pages carry a missing or placeholder meta description
5. **High:** Every commercial capabilities page is thin content, 228 to 535 words

Quick Wins:

1. Delete /sample-page, /hello-world, and /test in WordPress, then resubmit the sitemap - removes 3 thin indexable pages in minutes
2. Add 'Sitemap: https://daviselen.com/sitemap_index.xml' to robots.txt - one line, currently absent
3. Remove 'Crawl-delay: 3' from robots.txt - ignored by Google, actively throttles Bing for no benefit
4. Add width and height attributes plus loading=lazy to images - this is the single largest CLS and page-weight win available
5. Add alt text to the 9 images in the shared capabilities template - one component fix corrects 9 pages at once

2. Audit Categories

2.1 Technical SEO

Score: **62/100**

What Works

- HTTPS enforced; http:// and www. both 301 to the canonical https://daviselen.com/ apex
- Self-referencing canonical tags present on every page checked
- Genuine 404 status returned for non-existent URLs (verified with and without trailing slash)
- Yoast sitemap index is valid and segmented: post, page, project, category, author
- Fastly CDN in front of Flywheel; cached TTFB measured at 0.03s
- No AI crawler blocks - GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot and CCBot are all permitted, which is the correct default

Findings

robots.txt omits the Sitemap directive High

No 'Sitemap:' line anywhere in robots.txt, so crawlers must discover sitemap_index.xml by convention alone.

Recommendation: Add 'Sitemap: https://daviselen.com/sitemap_index.xml' to robots.txt.

'Disallow: /*?' blocks every query-string URL and contradicts the site's own WebSite schema High

The wildcard blocks ?s= search results and would block any future paginated or filtered URL. Meanwhile the WebSite JSON-LD declares a SearchAction targeting https://daviselen.com/?s={search_term_string}, a URL pattern robots.txt forbids.

Recommendation: Replace the blanket wildcard with disallow rules for specific tracking parameters, or remove it and control indexing with canonical tags.

'Crawl-delay: 3' throttles Bing for no benefit Medium

Google ignores crawl-delay entirely; Bing honours it, so this only slows Bing discovery.

Recommendation: Delete the Crawl-delay line.

Cold-cache TTFB reaches 4.7 seconds on a primary service page Medium

Measured TTFB: /capabilities/advertising 4.70s cold, /capabilities/digital 1.36s, /about 0.94s, / 0.03s on a Fastly HIT. Origin response is the variable, not the CDN.

Recommendation: Investigate origin PHP/plugin time on capabilities templates and extend Fastly cache TTL so these pages stay warm.

Security headers are nearly absent **Medium**

Only 'referrer-policy: no-referrer-when-downgrade' is set. No HSTS, no Content-Security-Policy, no X-Frame-Options, no Permissions-Policy.

Recommendation: Add Strict-Transport-Security, a baseline CSP, X-Frame-Options and Permissions-Policy at the Flywheel/Fastly layer. Not a direct ranking factor, but a trust and E-E-A-T signal.

2.2 Content Quality (E-E-A-T)

Score: **35/100**

What Works

- Genuine experience signals exist in the copy: 75+ years in business, Toyota for 5 decades, McDonald's for 6, \$18 billion in annual retail sales
- Real third-party validation is linked out: NBA.com Lakers, Innovid case study, One Club award, PadSquad case study
- /privacy-policy is substantive at 7,909 words

Findings

All 9 capabilities pages are thin **High**

Word counts: advertising 535, digital 344, multicultural 331, activations 331, packaging 326, branding 309, pr-social 311, experiential 268, who 228. These are the site's commercial pages and cannot compete for '[service] agency los angeles' style queries at this depth.

Recommendation: Expand each to 800+ words with named client work, campaign results, process detail and team credentials.

Homepage carries only 194 rendered words **High**

Playwright body innerText word count is 194 against a 171 KB HTML payload. The page is almost entirely video and styling.

Recommendation: Add substantive positioning copy that states who the agency serves, in which categories, with what proof.

WordPress demo content is publicly live **Critical**

/sample-page, /hello-world and /test all return 200 and sit in the sitemap.

Recommendation: Delete all three in WordPress. Do not noindex - delete, then confirm 404/410 and resubmit the sitemap.

The only page with real depth is the legal boilerplate **Medium**

/privacy-policy at 7,909 words dwarfs every commercial page on the site, and it carries two <h1> elements and no meta description.

Recommendation: Fix the duplicate H1, add a meta description, and treat the depth gap as the content roadmap's starting signal.

Two near-empty pages sit in the sitemap **Medium**

/capabilities-deck is 124 words and /davis-elene-advertising-retail-presence-map is 19 words.

Recommendation: Either build these out or noindex them and drop them from the sitemap.

2.3 On-Page SEO

Score: **30/100**

What Works

- Title tags are present and unique on all 30 pages, mostly within the 28-72 character range
- Canonical URLs are correct sitewide
- Primary navigation exposes real crawlable <a href> links to /work, /about, /careers and /contact

Findings

25 of 30 pages have no <h1>; the homepage has no heading of any level **Critical**

Only /about (1), /about-leadership (1) and /privacy-policy (2, a duplicate) contain an H1. The rendered homepage DOM returns headingsTotal: 0 across h1 through h6. Search engines and LLM retrieval pipelines both chunk pages by heading hierarchy; with none present, each page is one undifferentiated blob. This single defect simultaneously depresses On-Page, Content Quality and AI Search Readiness.

Recommendation: Add one semantic <h1> per page and convert styled section divs into <h2>/<h3>. Fix the duplicate H1 on /privacy-policy.

17 pages have no meta description **High**

Affected: all 9 /capabilities/*, /careers, /privacy-policy, /toyota-ugc, /lively-sim, /capabilities-deck, /test, /davis-elene-advertising-retail-presence-map, and 3 of 4 position pages.

Recommendation: Write unique 135-160 character descriptions for each.

6 pages ship the literal Yoast placeholder description High

/contact, /about-leadership, /game-on, /smart-final-alex, /de-tuesdays and /position-project-manager all serve: 'Add a description about your page or projects. Should be around 135 to 160 characters.'

Recommendation: Replace all six immediately - this text is visible in SERP snippets.

Only 3 of 30 pages have a real meta description High

/ (130 chars), /work (158 chars) and /about (165 chars, 5 over the practical truncation limit).

Recommendation: Trim /about to under 160 and treat these three as the template for the other 27.

Homepage does not link to any capabilities page Medium

All 9 /capabilities/* URLs are linked only from /work. /about and /careers link to none of them. This concentrates all capability-page authority behind a single hub.

Recommendation: Add contextual links to capabilities pages from the homepage and from /about.

og:title drops the brand differentiator Low

og:title is 'Davis Elen Advertising' while the <title> is 'Davis Elen Advertising - The oldest independent agency on the West Coast'. Social shares lose the positioning line.

Recommendation: Align og:title and twitter:title with the full title tag.

2.4 Schema / Structured Data

Score: 45/100

What Works

- Valid Yoast @graph on every page: WebPage, BreadcrumbList, WebSite, Organization
- Organization includes logo as a proper ImageObject with dimensions and caption
- sameAs covers Facebook, X, Instagram, YouTube and LinkedIn
- inLanguage set to en-US consistently

Findings

Organization is missing every local and entity property that matters **High**

No address, no telephone, no foundingDate, no numberOfEmployees, and the generic Organization type rather than the AdvertisingAgency subtype. The site publicly states 75+ years in business and lists six offices, none of it marked up.

Recommendation: Upgrade to @type AdvertisingAgency with postalAddress, telephone +1-213-688-7000, foundingDate and numberOfEmployees.

Four open job postings carry no JobPosting schema **High**

/position-copywriter, /position-art-director, /position-production-designer and /position-project-manager return only the generic Yoast graph. Without JobPosting they are ineligible for Google Jobs.

Recommendation: Add JobPosting to all four with title, description, datePosted, validThrough, hiringOrganization, jobLocation and baseSalary where disclosable.

Six office locations have no LocalBusiness markup **High**

Los Angeles HQ, San Diego, Seattle, Arlington, Kansas City and Denver appear on /contact as plain unmarked text.

Recommendation: Add a LocalBusiness entity per office. Six locations is well under the 30-page location quality gate, so dedicated location pages are safe to build - provided each carries genuinely local content rather than a city-swapped template.

Leadership page has no Person schema **Medium**

/about-leadership renders 78 images (headshots) with no Person entities, so no author or executive entity graph exists.

Recommendation: Add Person schema per executive with name, jobTitle, image and worksFor pointing at the Organization @id.

BreadcrumbList contains a single 'Home' item on every page **Low**

Yoast default, never configured, so no page communicates its position in the hierarchy.

Recommendation: Configure breadcrumb depth in Yoast so /capabilities/* pages emit Home > Capabilities > [Service].

2.5 Performance (Core Web Vitals)

Score: **35/100**

What Works

- LCP measured at 1,524 ms, inside the 2.5s 'good' threshold
- FCP at 1,188 ms
- Light DOM: 588 nodes on the homepage
- Only one long task recorded during load

Findings

CLS of 0.58 against a 0.10 'good' threshold **Critical**

Two layout shifts with no recent input. Root causes: images served without width/height attributes, and the hero video replacing its placeholder after load.

Recommendation: Set intrinsic width/height on every image and reserve an aspect-ratio box for the hero video container.

Homepage transfers 30.1 MB **Critical**

Breakdown: video 25,474 KB (homepageLoop-6.mp4 alone), CSS 2,530 KB across 12 files, images 1,272 KB, scripts 788 KB. DE4-TYT-Thumb-Long.jpg is 1,700 KB by itself.

Recommendation: Compress and re-encode the hero video, or poster-frame it and load on interaction. Target under 3 MB total.

2.5 MB of CSS across 12 separate files **High**

Twelve render-blocking stylesheets totalling more than the entire recommended page budget.

Recommendation: Concatenate, purge unused rules and inline critical CSS.

INP not measurable without field data **Info**

INP requires real user interaction data from CrUX. No Google API key is configured, so no field measurement was possible in this run.

Recommendation: Configure a GOOGLE_API_KEY and re-run to capture CrUX p75 INP, LCP and CLS with 25 weeks of history.

2.6 AI Search Readiness (GEO)

Score: **30/100**

What Works

- No AI crawler is blocked in robots.txt - GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, CCBot and Google-Extended all have access
- Organization entity with sameAs gives AI systems a resolvable brand identity
- External third-party citations (Innovid, One Club, NBA.com, PadSquad) corroborate claims made on-site

Findings

No heading structure means no citable passages **Critical**

AI retrieval systems extract and cite passage-level chunks bounded by headings. With zero headings sitewide, there is nothing for a retrieval pipeline to isolate and quote.

Recommendation: Fixing the heading defect is the single highest-leverage GEO action available; every other GEO improvement depends on it.

Content depth is below the citation threshold **High**

194-535 words per page gives AI systems almost nothing quotable about services, process or results.

Recommendation: Pair the content expansion with explicit, self-contained factual statements that read correctly when quoted out of context.

Entity data is incomplete for AI knowledge extraction **Medium**

No address, telephone, founding date or employee count in structured data, so AI systems cannot confidently resolve the firm's size, age or locations.

Recommendation: Complete the Organization/AdvertisingAgency entity as described in the Schema findings.

No llms.txt file present **Low**

<https://daviselen.com/llms.txt> returns 404. Google Search ignores llms.txt entirely; treatment by ChatGPT and Perplexity is unconfirmed.

Recommendation: Low cost, unproven benefit. Backlog item, not a priority - do not displace heading or content work for it.

2.7 Images

Score: **45/100**

What Works

- Homepage, /about, /work, /careers and the position pages have complete alt coverage
- Logo delivered as SVG
- Only one homepage image lacks alt text

Findings

9 images missing alt text on every capabilities page **Medium**

Identical count of 9 across all 9 /capabilities/* pages, indicating a single shared template component is at fault.

Recommendation: Fix the one component - it corrects 81 image instances across 9 pages.

Zero lazy loading sitewide **Medium**

Playwright reports lazyImgs: 0. Every below-fold image loads eagerly, including 78 headshots on /about-leadership and 71 images on /about.

Recommendation: Add loading=lazy to all below-fold images.

No modern image formats in use **Medium**

Only jpg, png and svg are served. No WebP or AVIF anywhere. DE4-TYT-Thumb-Long.jpg is 1,700 KB and would be roughly 150 KB as WebP.

Recommendation: Convert raster images to WebP with jpg/png fallback via <picture>.

Images lack intrinsic dimensions **Medium**

Directly contributes to the 0.58 CLS finding.

Recommendation: Emit width and height attributes from the WordPress media pipeline.

2.8 DE5 Rebuild Risk

Score: **40/100**

What Works

- Modern stack in the local repository: React 18, Vite, Tailwind, GSAP, React Router 7

- Playwright visual regression tests already wired up in the project
- Rebuild is pre-launch, so SEO defects can be prevented rather than retrofitted

Findings

Client-rendered SPA with no SSR or prerender step **High**

The local repository (davis-elen-website 5.1.2-alpha) is a React Router SPA built with Vite. Without server-side rendering or a prerender step, the initial HTML response is an empty shell. This is a harder version of the current site's problem, not a fix for it.

Recommendation: Add SSR or static prerendering before launch, and verify that view-source (not just the rendered DOM) contains titles, meta descriptions, headings and body copy.

Heading semantics must be enforced in components **High**

The live site's zero-heading defect comes from styling divs as display type. The same pattern in React components would carry the defect straight through the rebuild.

Recommendation: Add a lint rule or review gate requiring semantic h1-h6 for all display type, and assert one H1 per route in the existing Playwright suite.

Per-route meta tags need explicit handling **Medium**

React Router does not manage document head by default, so per-route titles and descriptions must be wired deliberately.

Recommendation: Implement per-route head management and port the corrected meta descriptions from the DE4 fixes rather than re-authoring them.

3. Action Plan

Phase 1 - Unblock (Critical) Week 1

- Delete /sample-page, /hello-world and /test in WordPress; verify they return 404; resubmit sitemap_index.xml
- Add a semantic <h1> to the 25 pages that have none, and convert styled section divs to <h2>/<h3>; fix the duplicate <h1> on /privacy-policy
- Add width and height attributes to all images and loading=lazy below the fold - this is the CLS fix and the largest page-weight win in one change
- Add 'Sitemap: https://daviselen.com/sitemap_index.xml' to robots.txt; remove 'Crawl-delay: 3'; narrow or remove 'Disallow: /*?'
- Falsifiability check: if non-brand GSC impressions stay flat 4-6 weeks after the heading fix, the constraint is content depth rather than markup

Phase 2 - On-Page and Weight Week 2

- Write 23 unique meta descriptions at 135-160 characters; eliminate all 6 Yoast placeholder strings; trim /about from 165 characters
- Re-encode the 25 MB hero video and compress the 1,700 KB JPEG; convert raster images to WebP; target under 3 MB total page weight
- Add alt text to the 9 images in the shared capabilities template component
- Consolidate the 12 CSS files and purge unused rules
- Falsifiability check: re-measure CLS after the dimension fix. If still above 0.10, the shift source is the video container rather than the images

Phase 3 - Content and Schema Weeks 3-4

- Expand all 9 capabilities pages to 800+ words with named client work, campaign results, process detail and team credentials
- Add JobPosting schema to the 4 open position pages for Google Jobs eligibility
- Upgrade Organization to AdvertisingAgency with address, telephone, foundingDate and numberOfEmployees
- Add Person schema to the leadership team on /about-leadership
- Add contextual internal links from the homepage and /about to the capabilities pages
- Configure Yoast breadcrumb depth so capabilities pages emit Home > Capabilities > [Service]

Phase 4 - Local and Hardening Month 2

- Build 6 location pages (Los Angeles HQ, San Diego, Seattle, Arlington, Kansas City, Denver) with LocalBusiness schema and genuinely local content per office - no city-swap templating
- Add Strict-Transport-Security, Content-Security-Policy, X-Frame-Options and Permissions-Policy headers
- Investigate the 4.7s cold TTFB on capabilities templates and extend Fastly cache TTL
- Configure GOOGLE_API_KEY and Search Console OAuth, then re-run for CrUX field CWV, indexation coverage and query-level data
- Leading indicator to monitor: GSC Performance filtered to exclude brand terms - watch non-brand impressions weekly

Phase 5 - DE5 Launch Gate Before rebuild cutover

- Add SSR or static prerendering to the Vite build so crawlers receive populated HTML, not an empty React shell
- Enforce semantic h1-h6 in components via lint rule; assert exactly one H1 per route in the existing Playwright suite
- Wire per-route document head management for titles and meta descriptions
- Port the corrected DE4 metadata into DE5 rather than re-authoring it
- Capture a drift baseline on DE4 before cutover and compare post-launch: [/seo drift baseline daviselen.com](#)

Data Sources & Methodology

Source	Description	Update Frequency
PageSpeed Insights API	Lighthouse lab audit (mobile emulation, Moto G Power, slow 4G)	Real-time
Chrome UX Report (CrUX)	28-day rolling field data from real Chrome users	Daily ~04:00 UTC
CrUX History API	25-week p75 trend data per metric	Weekly
Google Search Console	Search Analytics (clicks, impressions, CTR, position)	2-3 day lag
URL Inspection API	Per-URL index status, coverage state, crawl info	Real-time (2,000/day)

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Methodology based on Google Web Vitals thresholds, Search Console documentation, and Lighthouse scoring algorithms.